

Uddannelsesmuligheder efter Folkeskole



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Eritrea. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in Danish. What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that — it's great that you're thinking seriously about your next steps already. Since you're 16, just finished primary school (which in Denmark typically means **Folkeskole up to 9th or 10th grade**), and you're fluent in Danish, you have several solid options ahead depending on your **interests, strengths, and career goals**.

🎓 Main Educational Paths After Folkeskole in Denmark

Here are the three broad types of upper secondary education you can choose from:

1. General Upper Secondary Education (Gymnasiale uddannelser)

This is for you if you're interested in further academic education at university later.

Options:

- **STX (Alment gymnasium)** – general academic subjects like Danish, history, science, languages.
- **HHX (Handelsskolen)** – focus on business, economics, and marketing.
- **HTX (Teknisk gymnasium)** – science and technology focus.
- **HF (Højere forberedelseseksamen)** – 2-year general academic program (more practical/alternative path than STX).

✅ Good if you want to go to university later.

❌ Can be theory-heavy if you're more hands-on or practical.

2. Vocational Education and Training (Erhvervsuddannelse, EUD/EUX)

If you're more into **practical, hands-on work** (e.g., mechanics, carpentry, hairdressing, health care), vocational training is a strong option.

- **EUD** – Purely vocational, leads directly to a job.
- **EUX** – Combines vocational training with academic courses, so you can also go to university later if you want.

✅ You get paid during your apprenticeship. High demand for skilled workers.

❌ Can be harder to switch to university later unless you take the EUX path.

3. 10th Grade (10. klasse)

If you're unsure what to choose or need to improve your grades or confidence before moving on, this is a one-year option. Some choose this to mature or explore interests (and many "efterskoler" also offer 10th grade).

- ✓ Helps if you're not quite sure or want more time to decide.
- ✗ Adds an extra year without a qualification by itself.

🤔 How to Decide?

Here are a few personal questions to reflect on:

- Do you enjoy school subjects like Danish, English, science, or math?
- Do you prefer **hands-on learning** or **reading/writing/theory**?
- Do you think you want to go to university one day?
- Are you interested in **business, technology, health, arts**, etc.?

👍 Suggested Pathways Based on Different Goals

Your Interest/Goal	Recommended Path
I want to go to university	STX, HHX, HTX, or HF
I like science/technology	HTX or EUX in a technical field
I want to earn money & start working	EUD or EUX
I like business or entrepreneurship	HHX or EUX with a business focus
I need time to decide or improve	10th Grade (possibly at an Efterskole)

✍️ Final Thoughts for You

Since you're bilingual, culturally aware, and just finishing primary school in Denmark, you're in a strong position. Here's a safe starting recommendation:

- **If you're still unsure:** Consider **10th grade** to give yourself time to think.
- **If you enjoy academic subjects and might want university later:** Go for **STX, HHX, or HTX**, depending on your interests.
- **If you're more practical and want to start working sooner:** Look into **EUX** to keep your options open.

If you tell me more about your **interests, strengths, or dreams**, I can give you a more specific recommendation. Would you like to do that?